CONNECT DAILY

Monday 2 November 2026
themapsproject.com

A daily scan of national and South Yorkshire developments in education policy, inclusion, SEND, behaviour and accountability — weighted to primary and evidence sources, with links and a clear "so what for your school" line on the items that matter.

Useful? Forward it to a colleague. To join the circulation or partner with the network, get in touch.

TOP LINE

- Genuinely quiet 24-48 hours nationally and in Sheffield - no major DfE, Ofsted or local stories broke over the weekend, so today's edition runs short rather than padded.
- Correction to flag: the NEU's formal pay/funding strike ballot is paused, not open - drop any reference to it closing 15 December.
- Sheffield's community and voluntary-controlled schools return from half term today; academies can set their own dates, so some may differ.
- Worth a diary note: DfE's call for evidence on school exclusion reform closes in under three weeks, on 19 November.

→ **For your school:** *Consider whether the MAPs programme's alternative-provision experience is worth feeding into that call before it closes.*

DATES FOR THE DIARY

2 Nov 2026 — Sheffield's community and voluntary-controlled schools return from autumn half term (academies may vary).

19 Nov 2026 — DfE's call for evidence on school exclusion reform (behaviour strategies, in-school units, managed moves) closes.

Early 2027 — UK City of Culture 2029 winner announced; Sheffield is one of four finalists.

BEHAVIOUR, EXCLUSIONS & INCLUSION

▪ **Exclusion reform evidence call closes 19 November.** DfE's call for evidence on school exclusion reform - covering behaviour management strategies, in-school units and managed moves - closes in under three weeks. Responses will feed into the government's wider 'Every child achieving and thriving' reform programme, so it's a live channel for sector views on AP and inclusion practice rather than a done deal. (GOV.UK)

→ **For your school:** *Flag the 19 November deadline to anyone in the MAPs network who wants to submit evidence.*

PAY & FUNDING - CORRECTION

▪ **NEU ballot is paused, not live.** Contrary to a line that's been doing the rounds, the NEU's national executive paused its planned formal strike ballot over pay, funding and workload in late September, after the government ruled out clawing back schools' pension-contribution savings. No new ballot date has been set, so the 15 December closing date some coverage still cites is out of date. (LBC / NEU)

SHEFFIELD & SOUTH YORKSHIRE

▪ **Back from half term, on a high.** Sheffield's community and voluntary-controlled schools return today. Over half term, The Star's round-up of recent Ofsted outcomes highlighted a strong run for the city, with ten schools and nurseries inspected describing them as happy, welcoming and ambitious. (The Star)

DATA POINT OF THE WEEK

19 Nov

Closing date for DfE's call for evidence on school exclusion reform, covering behaviour strategies, in-school units and managed moves.

GOV.UK call for evidence

MAPS IN PRACTICE – TOOL SPOTLIGHT: SCHOOL+

A strong inclusion strategy is only as good as the cohort picture beneath it.

School+ is the MAPs cohort-vulnerability framework — it maps who your at-risk pupils are and why, giving your inclusion strategy an evidence base rather than a wish list. Explore School+

SOURCES MONITORED

Weighted official- and evidence-first. X is monitored for early signals from official accounts and named commentators, and corroborated against a primary source before anything is included.

Source	Type	What we track
OFFICIAL & STATUTORY		
DfE / GOV.UK	Government	Policy, funding, statutory guidance and statistics
Ofsted	Government	Inspection framework, report cards, annual report
Explore Education Statistics	Government data	Exclusions, suspensions, attendance, census data
House of Commons Library	Parliament	Neutral briefings on bills and policy
RESEARCH & EVIDENCE		
Education Endowment Foundation	Research	Evidence-based guidance, incl. inclusive teaching
NFER	Research	Assessment, workforce, disadvantage
Education Policy Institute	Think tank	Policy analysis and the disadvantage gap
Institute for Fiscal Studies	Think tank	School funding and spending analysis
FFT Education Datalab	Data analysis	Data-driven analysis of attainment and exclusions
INCLUSION & PREVENTION SPECIALISTS		
The Difference	Charity	Whole-school inclusion; “Who’s Losing Learning?”
IPPR	Think tank	Lost learning, exclusions, SEND reform
Youth Endowment Fund	Research	What works to prevent youth violence & exclusion
Centre for Social Justice	Think tank	Exclusion tracker and social-mobility policy
Whole School SEND	Network	SEND practice, resources and reviews
SECTOR PRESS & COMMENTARY		
Schools Week	Press	Breaking sector news and investigations
Tes	Press	Practice, policy and workforce
The Guardian (Education)	Press	National coverage and comment
X (monitored)	Social	DfE, Ofsted, EEF and named voices — corroborated before use
LOCAL & REGIONAL		
The Star (Sheffield)	Local press	Local schools and Ofsted outcomes
Sheffield City Council	Local government	Council decisions, funding and local strategy
South Yorkshire MCA & Careers Hub	Regional	Regional skills, careers and funding

Connect Daily is part of Sheffield Connect. Compiled by Andy Marsden, Sector Inclusion Lead.

For circulation across the network and partners. Figures reflect the latest published data at the date of this brief.